



False start: During his 12-ball stay against South Africa, the out-of-form Abhishek played seven false shots before falling for 15. VIJAY SONEJI

the pressure of a final.

The Under-19 boys winning the World Cup shows that there is talent aplenty in Indian cricket. But often the performers in the Ranji Trophy do not get the recognition their deeds deserve.

Where are the stories of players like Ravichandran Smaran, Ayush Doseja, Sanat Sangwan, Sudip Kumar Gharami, Abhinav Tejrana, Siddhesh Lad, Aman Mokhade, Armaan Jaffer and Kunal Chandela, who have all scored over 700 runs this year?

Where are the write-ups on Mayank Mishra and Siddharth Desai, to name two bowlers who have taken more than 40 wickets this season? Yes, there have been write-ups about Auqib Nabi. But could that be because he was snapped up in the IPL auction? If that had not happened, he, too, would perhaps have been

ignored. Like the names mentioned above.

The Ranji Trophy is the National Championship and should therefore be given prominence. Perhaps because the players are not always on television, like the U-19 and IPL boys, their efforts do not get the gushing headlines that others receive.

Then there is the lament that U-19 World Cups and the IPL are a shortcut to the India cap. But who is to be blamed? Only the selectors? Or also those who sideline Ranji Trophy performers to some remote corner of their papers, or do not even mention them on their television shows and public media platforms?

With India on the back foot in the World Cup, hopefully, the Ranji Trophy final will get more coverage. Or is that too much to hope for?



During their partnership, Brevis showed great maturity by letting Miller dominate the scoring while he himself settled in. This was hardly seen in the Indian batting approach as they looked to chase down the target set by the Proteas.